1. Platform Selection

Our selected platform is Hiredly, a Malaysian AI-enabled recruitment platform operated by Agensi Pekerjaan Wobb Sdn Bhd. Its AI features include personalised job recommendations, application screening, resume summarisation and a "Digital Headhunter" (Bob) that invites candidates to apply.

Hiredly meets the selection criteria because it is available as a mobile app and website, and every member can register a free account. It is local and niche, unlike JobStreet and LinkedIn, which operate regionally and globally. We found no ethical academic studies of Hiredly in Google Scholar or the university library databases. We also chose it because its data collection and AI use raise privacy, fairness and transparency concerns. As students about to enter the job market, we are among its target users.

2. Preliminary Investigation

We used four methods to avoid relying on one source. First, each member completed a hands-on walkthrough as a job seeker. Second, we analysed the Privacy Policy and Terms and Conditions against our observations. Third, we compared AI-generated outputs with their originals, such as summaries against full job advertisements. Lastly, we reviewed employer pricing and product pages for features that disadvantage job seekers.

2.1 Ethical Issues Identified

Issue 1: Unclear Use of Race in Job Matching

Hiredly's Privacy Policy lists race or ethnicity as "Demographic Information" it may collect, while stating it collects no sensitive personal data (Figure A1). Race is not sensitive under Malaysia's PDPA but is high-risk in hiring. Hiredly's Digital Headhunter invites the top 1,000 of over 1.3 million profiles to apply for each job (Figure A2), yet the policy does not disclose the ranking criteria or whether race is used. Even without direct use of race data, proxies such as names and language skills could reproduce Malaysia's hiring bias.

Clause 8.07 (no unfair treatment)

Race is irrelevant to job ability. However, if matching learns from employers' past practices or user behaviour (Figure A9) and uses race-related proxies, it could rank some ethnic groups lower, repeating the bias shown in Section 3.

Clause 1.06 (avoid deception)

Hiredly's Privacy Policy is a public statement about the software. It says no sensitive data is collected but lists race as data it may collect (Figure A1). Users may be misled about how such data is treated.

Clause 3.12 (respect user privacy)

Sign-up does not ask for race but requires nationality (Figure A3), while the policy says demographic information including race may be acquired from third parties for advertising (Figure A17), without stating whether job matching excludes it. Users therefore cannot control how race data they never provided is used.

Issue 2: Weak Consent and Control Over CV Sharing

Hiredly's Terms state that CVs in its resume database are automatically searchable by paying employers and recruiters, who browse and unlock resumes through Talent Search (Figures A4, A12). The Terms treat acceptance as "Express Consent" rather than asking separately, and sign-up says only that details are saved for future use (Figure A3). Employers may keep CV copies after removal, and Hiredly cannot guarantee other parties will not access the database (Figure A4). The Privacy Policy describes searchability as a choice, but the Terms say it is automatic. In our test account, the visibility toggle was on by default before any resume was uploaded (Figure A5).

Clause 3.13 (use data only as authorised)

Treating acceptance of the Terms as consent (Figure A4) raises doubt that users properly authorised this use. Sign-up promises that salary is never shared with employers but gives no similar notice for CVs (Figure A3), and contact details are shared only if users opt in (Figure A16). This suggests Hiredly could obtain separate CV authorisation but does not.

Clause 6.07 (accurate statements about software)

Hiredly's Google Play label says no data is shared with third parties (Figure A6), yet employers can search CVs and keep copies (Figure A4). Even if technically true, the label implies CVs stay private, which Clause 6.07 prohibits.

Issue 3: Misleading AI-Generated Outputs

Hiredly promotes its AI job summaries as a way to apply in seconds (Figure A9). Each summary is labelled "AI-generated" without warning that it may omit or misstate details (Figure A7). Its HIRESUME tool's AI CV builder rewrites CVs. In its marketing example, "basic marketing reporting in Excel" becomes "integrating EPF and SOCSO structural criteria" (Figure A10), potentially overstating experience. Hiredly's Terms disclaim the accuracy and completeness of its content, so responsibility for errors is unclear. Job seekers may submit misleading CVs, and employers may receive inflated ones.

Clause 3.14 (maintain data integrity)

AI summaries may alter the employer's original posting (Figures A7, A8), and HIRESUME may alter a user's experience (Figure A10). However, summaries carry only an "AI-generated" label with no accuracy caution, and HIRESUME rewrites carry no marker. Both the employer's posting and the user's CV are data that the AI rewrites without safeguards to keep the content accurate, so users cannot tell what has changed.

Clause 6.07 (accurate statements about software)

Hiredly calls its AI output a summary, implying a neutral shortened version, but it omits the original post's "Red Flags" section and the platforms the intern would manage (Figures A7, A8). Claims such as "Scan and apply in seconds" and "ATS-friendly" (Figures A9, A10) also lack published evidence that we could find, overstating the reliability of its AI features.

Clause 3.01 (make trade-offs clear)

Hiredly promotes its AI summaries for faster applications, trading accuracy for speed, while HIRESUME prioritises polished keywords over faithful representation (Figure A10). Neither trade-off is disclosed, leaving users unaware of the risks.

Issue 4: Commercial Priorities Over Job Seekers

Job search is free for job seekers, while employers pay for posts, CV access and visibility add-ons: Refresher (RM50), Spotlight (RM100) and Featured (RM800) (Figure A11). No listing in our walkthrough carried a promotion label (Figure A13), though we cannot tell which were promoted. The Terms say Hiredly does not screen listings or take responsibility for their quality (Figure A14), but its retrenchment support page says every job is verified from a registered Malaysian employer (Figure A15). Unchecked listings, including fake ones collecting personal data, could therefore be promoted without job seekers knowing, leaving them to carry the risk.

Clause 1.02 (balance interests with the public good)

Paid promotion (Figure A11) and CV access favour employers, while the Terms disclaim responsibility for fake listings (Figure A14) and CV misuse (Figure A4). This design appears to favour employers over job seekers and the public.

Clause 1.06 (avoid deception)

The retrenchment support page says every job is verified (Figure A15). However, the Terms say Hiredly does not screen listings or confirm identities, and listings carry no warning that they are unchecked or promoted (Figure A13). Even if "verified" means only registration, users could reasonably take it to mean genuine jobs.

3. Literature Review

Bias in Candidate Matching (Issue 1)

Matching systems can inherit bias even when race is not an input. Bertrand and Mullainathan (2004) found callbacks depended on whether names sounded White or Black, and Lee and Khalid (2016) found Chinese applicants in Malaysia received more callbacks than Malay applicants. Therefore, systems trained on such decisions may learn the pattern. Removing race does not prevent this: Chen et al. (2018) found gender-related unfairness in resume search rankings although the engines did not use gender features. Wilson and Caliskan (2024) tested language-model resume retrieval and found candidates were treated differently by names alone, favouring White-associated names in 85.1% of cases. Raghavan et al. (2020) review what hiring vendors disclose about bias testing, which Hiredly's policy lacks.

Consent, Context and Labels (Issue 2)

Consent through Terms is weak. Obar and Oeldorf-Hirsch (2020) found 74% of students joining a fake social network skipped the privacy policy and nearly all missed clauses allowing data sharing with employers, similar to Hiredly's searchability clause. Nissenbaum (2004) argues data should be used only in ways matching why it was shared, so a user uploading a CV to apply expects that employer to see it, not every paying employer. Labels do not fix this, as Khandelwal et al. (2024) found Google Play data safety labels are often inconsistent. Obar and Oeldorf-Hirsch show users do not read terms, Nissenbaum shows reading would not be enough because use must match context, and Khandelwal shows labels cannot fill the gap.

Reliability of AI-Generated Content (Issue 3)

Maynez et al. (2020) found more than 70% of single-sentence summaries from tested models contained hallucinations, a problem Ji et al. (2023) found across text-generation tasks. Automated screening adds another risk. Fuller et al. (2021) found 88% of employers agree automated filters reject qualified high-skills candidates whose CVs lack exact criteria, which may push job seekers toward keyword-heavy CVs, as HIRESUME promises. Malaysia's voluntary AI guidelines recommend disclosing AI-generated content (Ministry of Science, Technology and Innovation, 2024). Together, these suggest Hiredly's summaries may misinform while its keyword-focused CV builder pushes users to over-optimise.

Paid Ranking (Issue 4)

Rochet and Tirole (2003) show platforms often keep one side's price low because its presence is valuable to the paying side, explaining free job seeker access but not fair treatment. In a field experiment randomising Expedia hotel rankings, Ursu (2018) found that position changes which options people click, not what they choose after clicking. Therefore, paid promotion may shape which posts job seekers view, not necessarily their choice. Lewandowski et al. (2018) found few of 1,000 search users could tell ads from organic results, so unlabelled promotion can mislead and Hiredly shows no such labels (Figure A13).

4. Ethical Framework Proposal

4.1 Where the Code Is Insufficient

The SE Code (ACM/IEEE-CS, 1999) cannot settle Issue 1. Clause 8.07 prohibits unfair treatment, but checking for it might require race data, while Clause 3.12 requires respecting privacy, suggesting that race should not be collected if matching does not need it. The preamble acknowledges that standards may conflict but not which clause prevails.

For Issue 4, pricing, labelling and liability terms are management decisions, not individual engineers'. Principle 2 asks engineers to serve employers consistently with the public interest but gives no balancing method. Clause 4.05 asks engineers to disclose unavoidable conflicts of interest but is not framed for conflicts built into the business itself, such as greater visibility for paying employers (Figure A11).

4.2 Choice of Ethical Theories

Because the Code cannot settle these issues, we select deontology and utilitarianism to judge them.

1. Deontology (Kantianism)

Deontology judges actions by whether they follow moral duties (rules), not outcomes (Kant, 1785/2019). It suits Issues 1 and 4 because both involve duties to job seekers, namely honesty about data collected (Issue 1, Figure A1) and about verified listings (Issue 4, Figures A14, A15). In both, Hiredly's claims contradict its own documents, thus breaching honesty. Kant's categorical imperative asks whether a rule could be universal; if every platform contradicted its own policies, none could be trusted. Kant also forbids treating people merely as a means, yet unlabelled paid promotion (Figures A11, A13) risks using job seekers to earn employer revenue.

2. Utilitarianism

Utilitarianism judges actions by consequences, aiming to maximise overall benefit (Mill, 1863). It suits Issues 1 and 4 because Hiredly's design affects over 1.3 million job seekers plus employers (Figure A2), so each issue weighs one group's gain against another's loss. For instance, free job search alongside paid promotion (Figure A11) is weighed against unchecked listings (Figure A14), and fast matching (Figure A2) against possible ethnic disadvantage. In utilitarianism, the right design is whichever produces the best overall consequences for all affected users.

However, the two ethical theories conflict. In Issue 1, deontology leaves fairness and privacy unranked, while utilitarianism could accept harm to a minority if most users benefit. In Issue 4, utilitarianism could accept unlabelled promotion because most users search free, whereas deontology forbids it. We therefore bring in Rawls' ethics of justice (Rawls, 1971) to further analyse these conflicts.

Rawls ranks basic freedoms first, and privacy is part of basic liberty, so in Issue 1 race data should be collected only voluntarily and kept separate from matching. Since inequalities are

acceptable only if they benefit the least advantaged, race data should be used only to check for bias against groups disadvantaged in Malaysian hiring (Lee & Khalid, 2016). In Issue 4, promotions favour paying employers (Figure A11) and we saw no promotion labels (Figure A13), so the arrangement benefits them rather than the least advantaged job seekers and is difficult to justify as fair.

4.3 Analytical Framework

To complete Part 2, we will assess each issue in five steps.

1. Collect new evidence. We will compare sign-up and profile screens with the Privacy Policy's demographic data list to observe what is collected, including race; compare Hiredly's consent settings with JobStreet and LinkedIn; examine more AI-generated summaries and test HIRESUME with dummy CVs; and repeat searches over two weeks to record listing positions and promotion labels.
2. Identify stakeholders and link each to the issues affecting them and the evidence.
3. Re-check the SE Code clauses against the new evidence.
4. Apply both theories to each issue and compare conclusions. Utilitarianism weighs harms against benefits, while deontology, supported by Rawls' ethics of justice for Issues 1 and 4, judges duties and fairness.
5. Reflect on conflicts between the Code and theories, then recommend improvements for Hiredly.

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Appendix A: Evidence from our walkthrough of Hiredly

All screenshots were taken by group members between 20 and 31 October 2026.

(b) Demographic Information is information that is not unique to you in the sense that it refers to selected population characteristics, such as your ZIP code or postal code, age, preferences, gender, race or ethnicity, occupation, career history, interests and favourites.

(c) We also collect behavioural information regarding how you use the Site and mobile applications, the areas of the Site that you visit, what services you access, and information about your computer hardware and software including your IP address, geolocation, browser and operating system type, domain names, access times and referring website addresses. This information is necessary for analyzing the use of resources, troubleshooting problems, preventing fraud, and improving our services.

(d) In addition, we may collect Indirect Information about you when you use certain third-party services on the Site and the collection of such information is considered necessary for that purpose.

We do not collect sensitive personal data or confidential information such as the password of your email account; password of your Hiredly account (as it is automatically encrypted and saved in the Hiredly database when you create an account or register with Hiredly and is not authorized for access by Hiredly unless desired under any legal obligation); financial information such as Bank Account details or Credit Card or Debit Card or other payment related details; physical and mental or other health conditions or medical records and history; Biometric information such as fingerprints, voice & facial patterns and DNA or any other sensitive information which is confidential or sensitive by its nature.

Figure A1. Hiredly's Privacy Policy (Hiredly, 2024), section "Types of Information Collected". Source: https://my.hiredly.com/privacy-policy (Updated 29th March 2024)

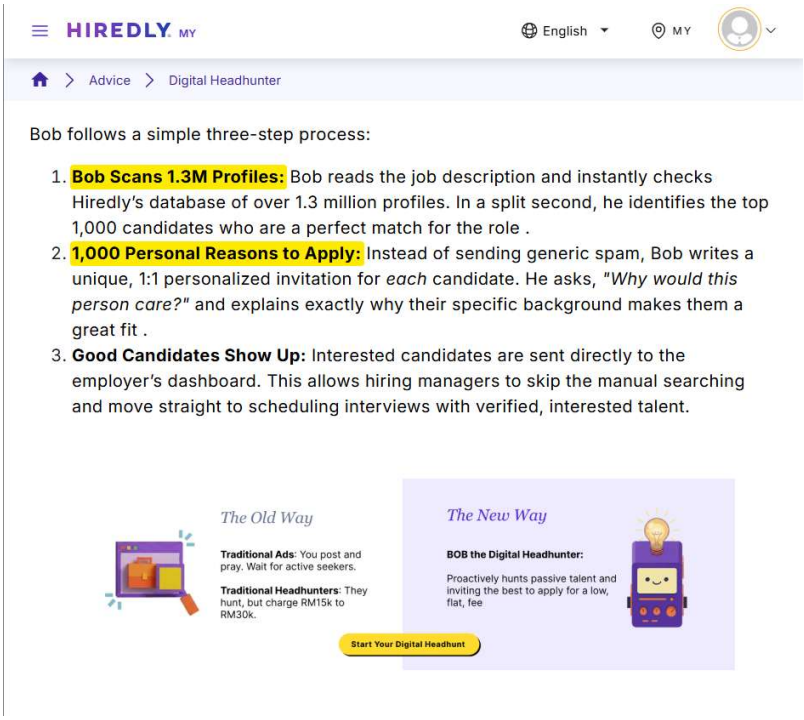


Figure A2. Hiredly's product description of its Digital Headhunter, "Bob" (Hiredly, 2026). Source: https://my.hiredly.com/advice/digital-headhunter (Updated 13th May 2026)

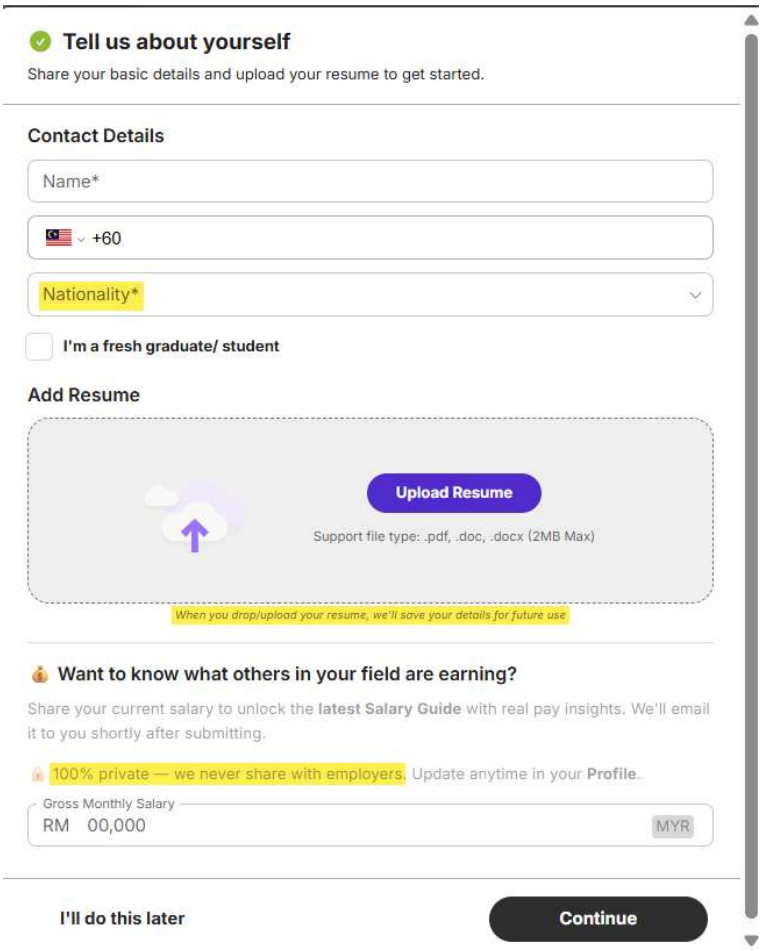


Figure A3. Hiredly's sign-up form.

11. Express Consent and Acknowledgement

11.1. You acknowledge, consent and agree that when submitting your resume for storage in our resume database, your resume is automatically searchable by employers, recruiters, hiring managers, headhunters, and human resource professionals (the "**Employers**") who pay for access to our resume database. Hiredly is not responsible for the use made of resumes by Employers who access your resume whilst it resides in our database. You acknowledge that when your resume is displayed in our database, personal information present within your resume (such as your email address), can be collected and used by parties other than the Employers. This may result in unsolicited messages from third parties for which Hiredly is not responsible for. Hiredly will attempt to limit access to our resume database to the Employers, but cannot guarantee that other parties will not gain access to this database. You may remove your resume from the Web Site at any time, but the Employers who have gained access to our database may have retained a copy of your resume in their own files or databases. Hiredly is not responsible for the retention, use or privacy of resumes or profiles in these instances.

Figure A4. Hiredly's Terms and Conditions, Clause 11.1 ("Express Consent and Acknowledgement"). Source: https://my.hiredly.com/terms-and-conditions

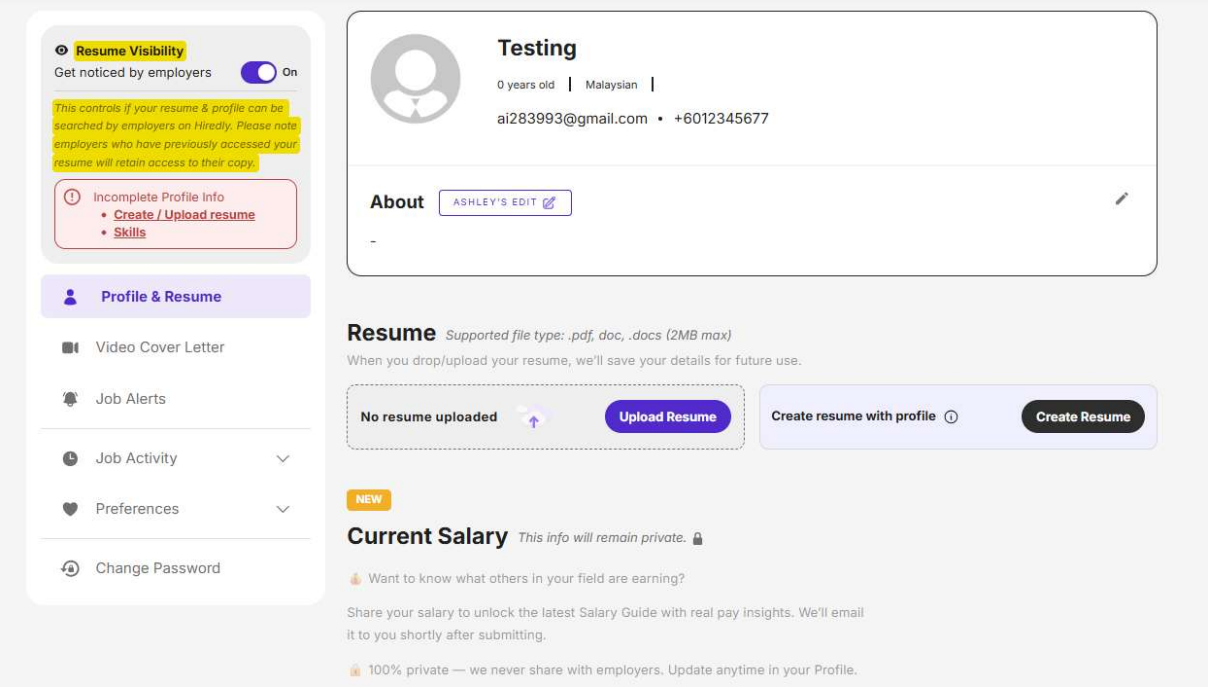


Figure A5. Hiredly's profile page (test account). "Resume Visibility" is switched on by default even when no resume has been uploaded.

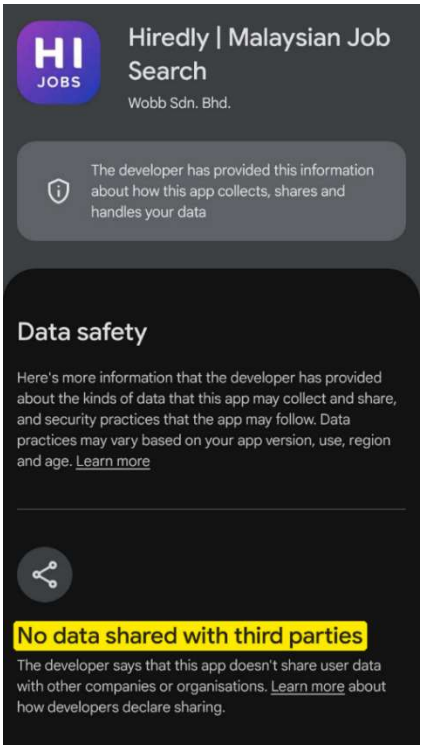


Figure A6. Hiredly's Google Play Data safety label (Google Play, 2026).

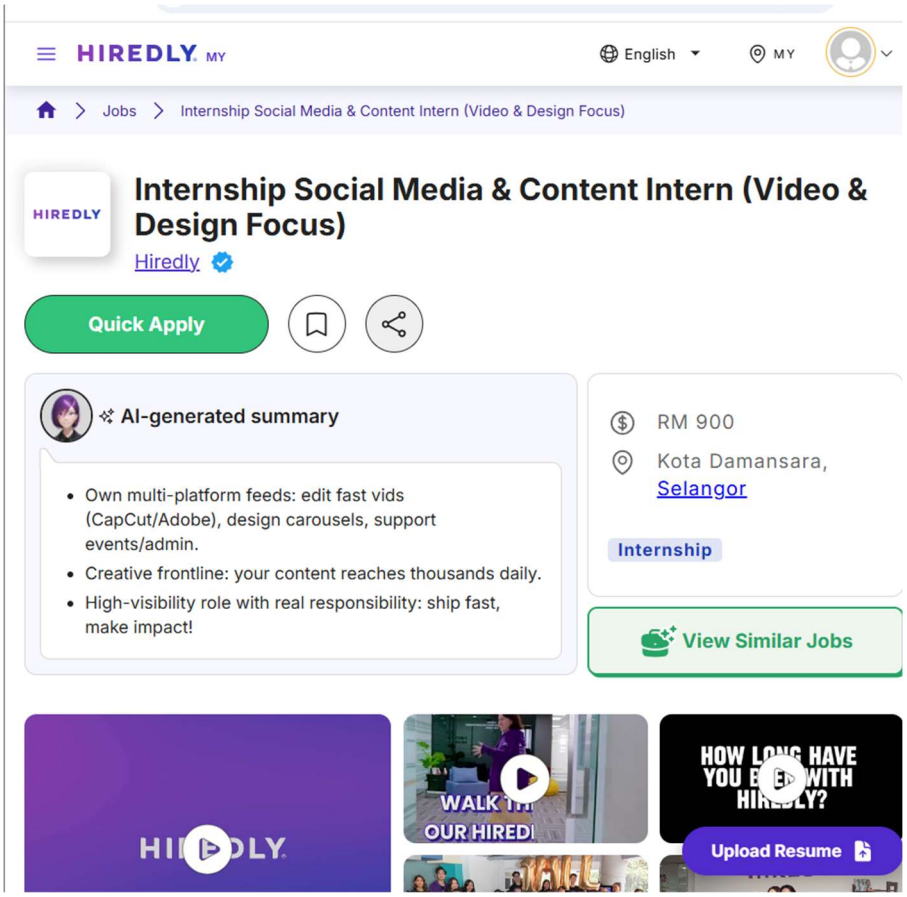


Figure A7. Hiredly's AI-generated summary of an internship post.

Job Description

The Vibe: Forget fetching coffee. At Hiredly, you're joining the creative frontline. We are looking for a content obsessionist who understands the nuances between a polished LinkedIn carousel and a chaotic Gen Z TikTok. You will be creating content that thousands of people see every day.

Your Mission:

- **Own the Feed:** Manage our presence across TikTok, LinkedIn, Meta (IG/FB), XiaoHongShu, and Douyin.
- **Master the Edit:** Produce high-quality, fast-paced videos using **CapCut/Adobe**. You know how to hook a viewer in the first 3 seconds.
- **Design That Pops:** Create beautiful, shareable carousels and graphics.
- **All-Rounder Support:** You are a true Swiss Army Knife. From helping set up university engagement booths to organizing office admin, you are the person we can count on to get things done.

🚩 **Red Flags (Do NOT Apply If):**

- **You move slowly.** We embrace speed. If you need 3 days to edit one 15-second video, you will struggle here.
- **You are disorganized.** We juggle multiple platforms. If you can't keep your files and schedule tight, you'll drown.
- **You get overwhelmed easily.** Things change fast here. We need someone who can pivot instantly without panicking.
- **You wait to be told what to do.** We want problem solvers with a "can-do" attitude, not order takers.

Figure A8. The full job description for the same post in Figure A7.

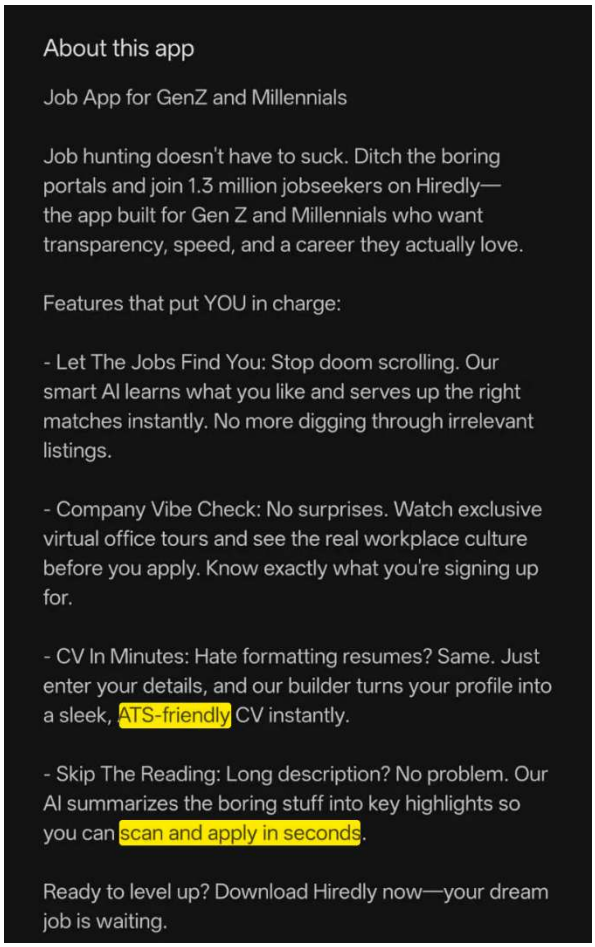


Figure A9. Hiredly's Google Play description (Google Play, 2026).

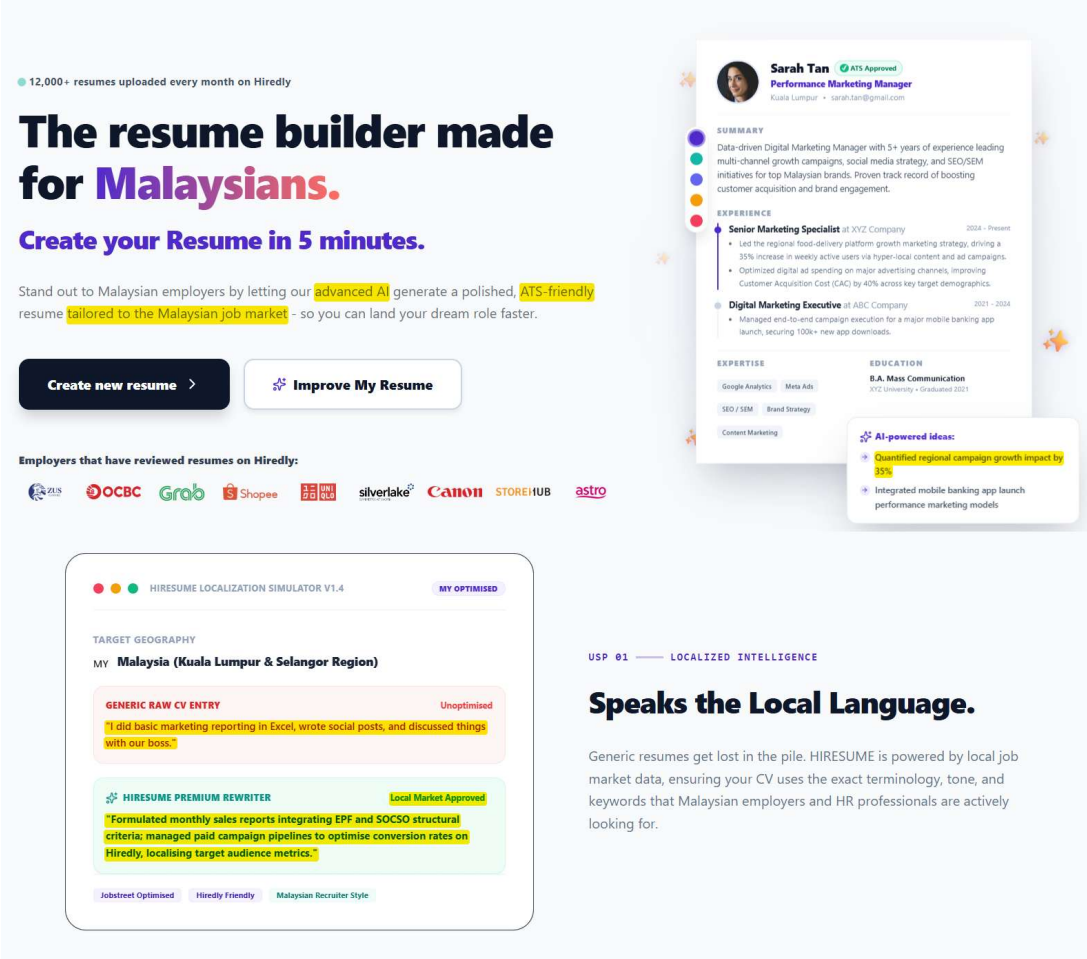


Figure A10. Hiredly's HIRESUME marketing page. Source: https://hiresume.my/

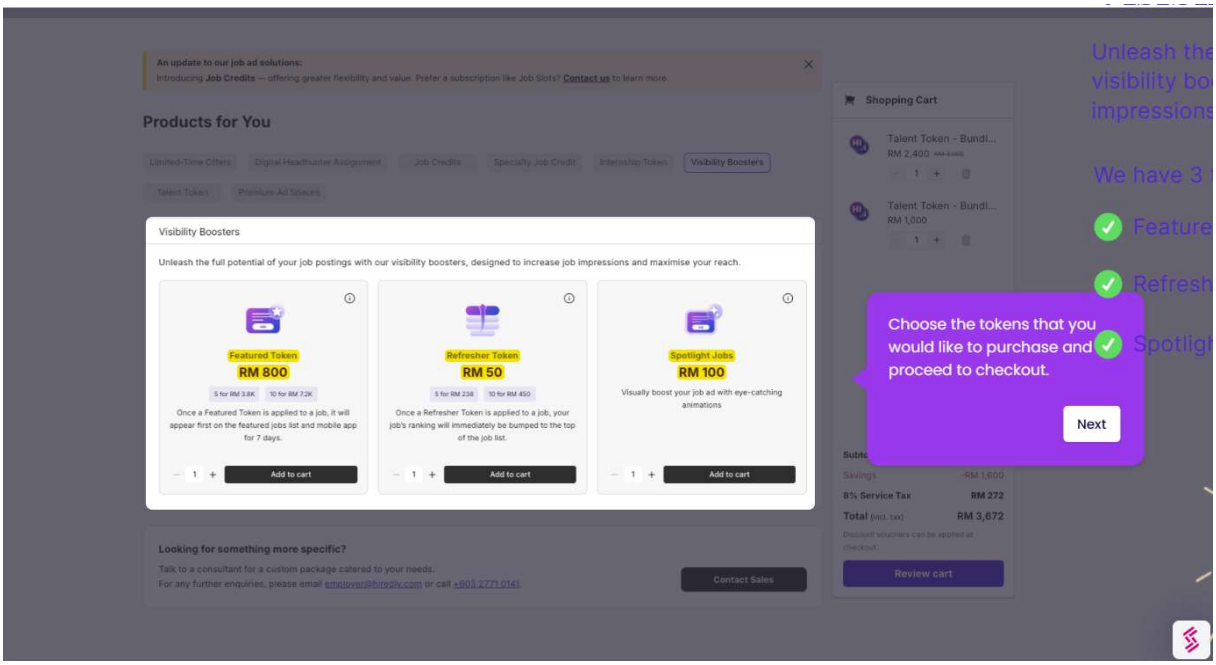


Figure A11. Hiredly's employer demo page on "Visibility Boosters". Source: https://hub.hiredly.com/copy-of-employer-demo-page

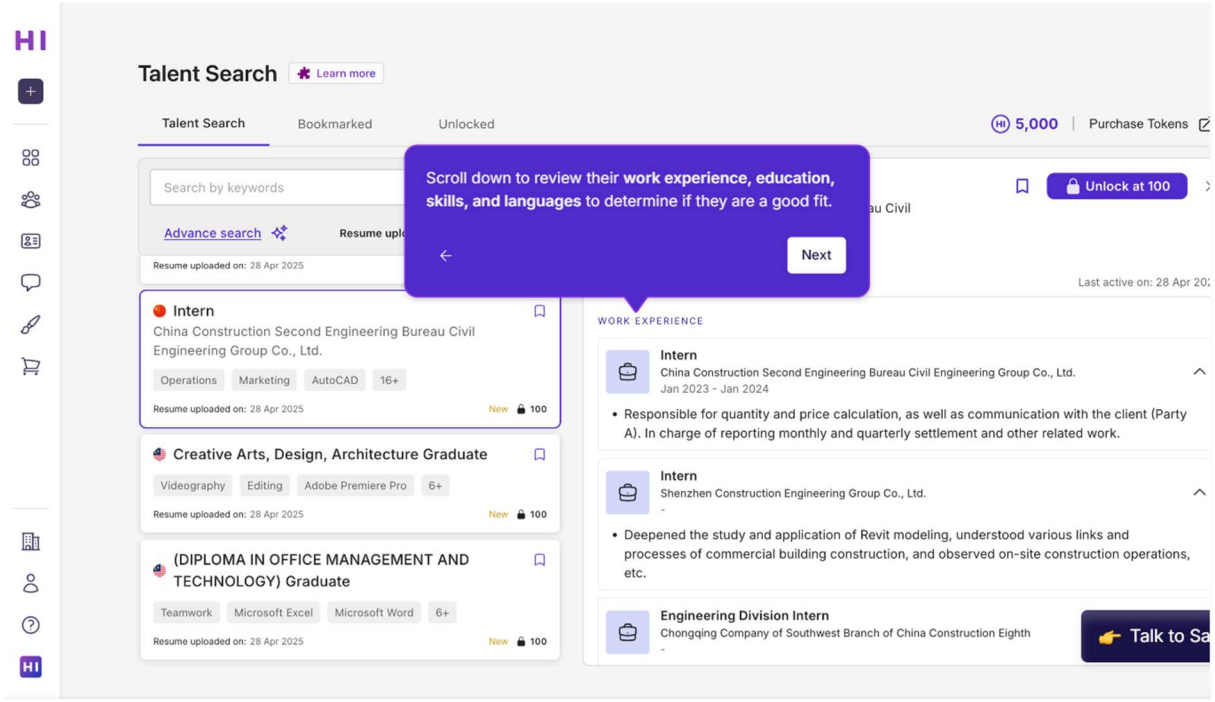


Figure A12. Hiredly's employer "Talent Search" demo. Source: https://hub.hiredly.com/copy-of-employer-demo-page

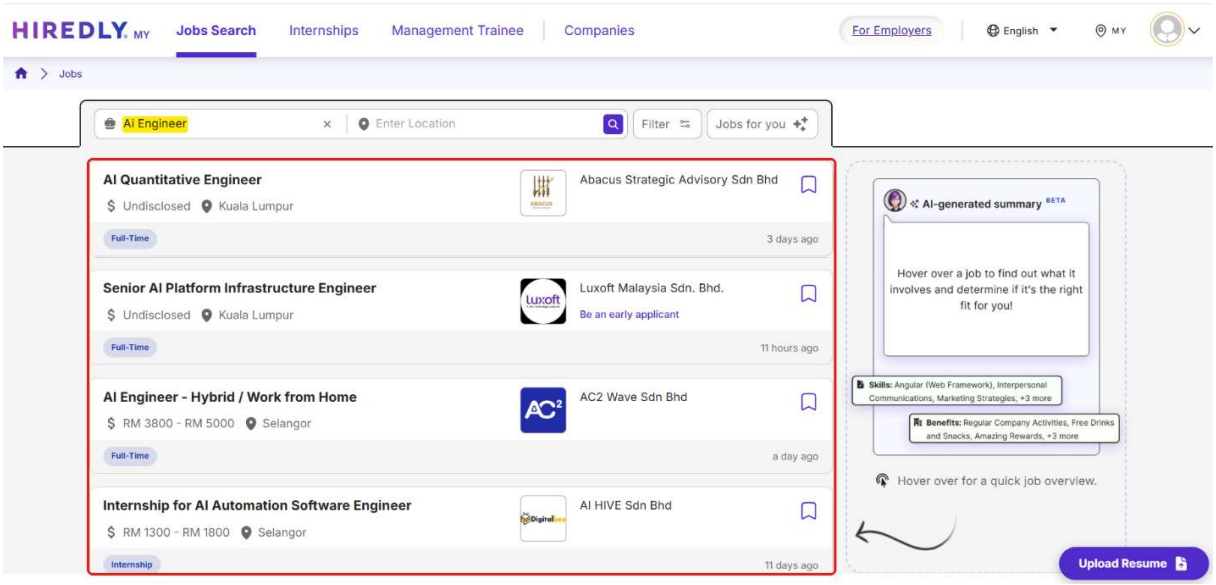


Figure A13. Hiredly's job search results on the website (search term: "Ai Engineer", no location filter applied).

14. Hiredly's Liability

14.1. The Web Site acts, among other things, as a venue for (i) Employers to post job opportunities and (ii) candidates to post resumes and Profiles and search for and evaluate job opportunities. Hiredly does not screen or censor the listings including Profiles offered. Hiredly is not involved in the actual transaction between employers and candidates. As a result, Hiredly is not responsible for User Content, the quality, safety or legality of the jobs or resumes posted, the truth or accuracy of the listings, the ability of Employers to offer job opportunities to candidates or the ability of candidates to fill job openings and Hiredly makes no representations about any jobs, Employers or listings. While Hiredly reserves the right in its sole discretion to remove User Content, job postings, resumes or other material from the Web Site from time to time, Hiredly does not assume any obligation to do so and to the extent permitted by law, disclaims any liability for failing to take any such action. Hiredly has no control over the accuracy, reliability, completeness, or timeliness of the Profiles or User Content submitted on the Web Site and makes no representations about any Profile, resumes or User Content on the Web Site.

Figure A14. Hiredly's Terms and Conditions, Clause 14.1 ("Hiredly's Liability"). Source: https://my.hiredly.com/terms-and-conditions

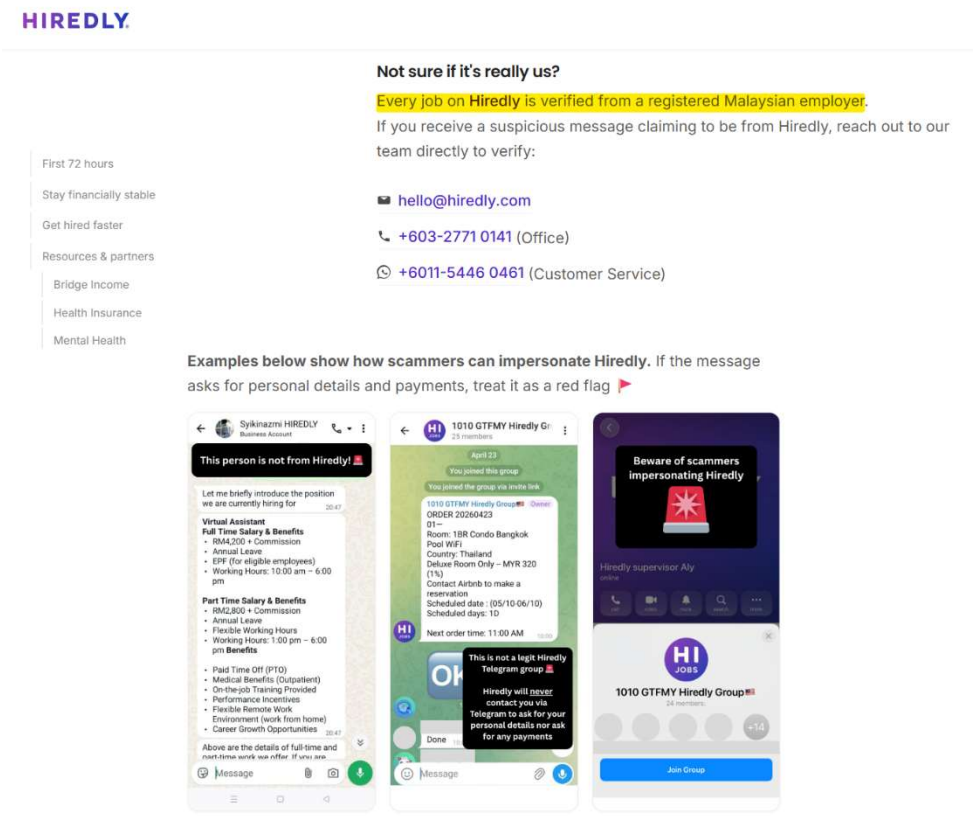


Figure A15. Hiredly's retrenchment support page, section "Avoid scams". Source: https://my.hiredly.com/retrenchment

k. to other third parties if you consent to such disclosure.

1. For example, if you make your resume searchable, then all parties with access to our searchable resume database (or copies thereof) will have access to your resume. If you indicate that you would like to receive information about the opportunities, products or services of third parties at the time you register for a Hiredly account, we supply your contact information to third parties such as employers, recruiters, data aggregators, marketers or others for the purpose of sending you email or otherwise communicating with you)
2. For example, if you indicate that you would like to receive information about the opportunities, products or services of third parties at the time you register for a Hiredly account, we supply your contact information to third parties such as employers, recruiters, data aggregators, marketers or others for the purpose of sending you email or otherwise communicating with you.

Figure A16. Hiredly's Privacy Policy (Hiredly, 2024), section "Transfer**"**. Source: https://my.hiredly.com/privacy-policy

(d) In addition, we may collect Indirect Information about you when you use certain third-party services on the Site and the collection of such information is considered necessary for that purpose.

We do not collect sensitive personal data or confidential information such as the password of your email account; password of your Hiredly account (as it is automatically encrypted and saved in the Hiredly database when you create an account or register with Hiredly and is not authorized for access by Hiredly unless desired under any legal obligation); financial information such as Bank Account details or Credit Card or Debit Card or other payment related details; physical and mental or other health conditions or medical records and history; Biometric information such as fingerprints, voice & facial patterns and DNA or any other sensitive information which is confidential or sensitive by its nature.

We may personalize the advertising that you are shown on the Site with which we have a business relationship. In order to provide this personalization, in addition to information we collect about you on the Site, we acquire information (including personal, demographic, behavioural and indirect information) about you from third parties who provide it to us.

Figure A17. Hiredly's Privacy Policy (Hiredly, 2024), section "Types of Information Collected". Source: https://my.hiredly.com/privacy-policy